

# EXCALIDRAW EXPORT BADGE

*Product Requirements Document: Net New Build*

**Build name:** Excalidraw Export Badge: a small, clickable Excalidraw logo on every export

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**Stakeholder:** Avni Nahar, Head of Marketing, Excalidraw

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## 1. PROBLEM

People who see a diagram made with Excalidraw, in a GitHub README, a design doc, a slide deck or a blog post, cannot tell which tool made it. None of Excalidraw's image exports (PNG, SVG or copy to clipboard) show a visible Excalidraw name, logo or link. Excalidraw grows mainly by word of mouth, so every shared diagram is a missed chance for someone new to discover it. Today 0% of image exports carry visible attribution, and the Head of Marketing has no way to measure or grow brand visibility from exports.

### Supporting Context

- **Export audit (September 13–15, 2026):** we exported every format on [excalidraw.com](https://excalidraw.com) and inspected the files. PNG files show nothing. SVG files carry only a hidden code comment. Images copied to the clipboard carry nothing, even with “Embed scene” on. Only shareable links show Excalidraw, through their preview card.
- **Excalidraw grows by being seen:** about 60,000 monthly users at the end of 2020 grew to about 850,000 in 2024, mostly by word of mouth (Excalidraw's year-end blog posts). The GitHub project has 131.7K stars (September 2026).
- **Users have asked for it:** On April 8, 2020 an optional “Made with Excalidraw” watermark was proposed (issue #1312), and Excalidraw shipped it 11 days later (PR #1365). It was dropped without any discussion in the 2021 export redesign (PR #3613), and the leftover code was removed the next day (PR #3639). In 2023 a user opened issue #6607 asking to bring it back because people ask where the diagrams come from, and it is still open. The text “Made with Excalidraw” is still translated in 57 language files in the code, unused.
- **Exports are not fully measured:** copies made with the right-click menu or Shift+Alt+C are sent as “element” events, which Excalidraw's analytics drop. A common way of sharing diagrams is invisible today.

### 1a. Opportunity

Turn every exported diagram into a small, clickable signpost back to Excalidraw. With the badge on by default in every image export, at least half of the exports in every format (Avni's 50% target) will name Excalidraw within three months of launch, and people who view SVG diagrams will be one click away from a free, ready-to-use canvas.

## Market Opportunity

- Excalidraw had about 850,000 monthly users in 2024 (Excalidraw blog). Every diagram they export reaches other people at no cost. Export tracking will give the exact volume.
- Signing free exports is a normal model. Whimsical's free exports carry "Made with Whimsical". Miro's Free plan has no high-resolution export without a watermark. draw.io hides the full editable diagram inside every PNG by default. In January 2026 tldraw's founder proposed a badge for brand visibility (issue #7698). FigJam's and Lucidchart's help pages mention no watermark (not tested, because both need an account to export).
- Competitive analysis: [Competitor Export Attribution](#). Evidence of today's exports: [Excalidraw Export Audit](#).

## 1b. Users & Needs

**Primary user(s):** Creators who draw on [excalidraw.com](#) and export diagrams to share: software engineers, product managers, teachers and writers. They care about a clean, professional diagram, speed, and not having to sign up.

**Secondary users:** Viewers who see those diagrams in docs, READMEs, slides and blogs (future Excalidraw users); Excalidraw's Head of Marketing, who reports brand visibility; and the Head of Product and engineers who build and track the feature.

### Key User Needs

As a creator, I need to share diagrams that still look like my own work, because I use them at work and a large logo would look unprofessional.

As a creator, I need to switch the badge off in one click, because some diagrams, such as client decks, must be completely clean.

As a viewer, I need to see which tool made a diagram, because I want to make diagrams like it.

As a viewer, I need to reach that tool in one step, because I will not go searching for it.

As the Head of Marketing, I need to count how many exports carry the badge and how many visits it brings, because I report brand visibility.

## 2. PROPOSED SOLUTION

The Excalidraw Export Badge is a small addition to Excalidraw's existing export feature: a tiny Excalidraw logo followed by the words "Made with [excalidraw.com](#)", placed in the bottom-right corner of every exported image. It is on by default, and anyone can switch it off with one toggle

in the Export image window. Where the format supports links (SVG), the badge is clickable and opens [excalidraw.com](https://excalidraw.com), where viewers can start drawing right away with no sign-up; in PNG and clipboard images, which cannot hold links, the logo and the readable address do the same job. As a result, every shared diagram tells people where it was made and how to get there, and Excalidraw can finally measure it.

## 2a. Value Proposition

Viewers of shared diagrams who cannot tell which tool made them, because Excalidraw exports carry no visible name or link, use the Excalidraw Export Badge, a small logo-and-link signature on every export, to recognise Excalidraw and open it in one click. Unlike a traditional watermark, it matches Excalidraw's hand-drawn style, sits outside the drawing, can be switched off by the creator in one click and does not track people, helping Excalidraw turn everyday sharing into measurable brand visibility and new users.

## 2b. Top 3 MVP Value Props

**The Vitamin** (*must-have baseline*): Every PNG, SVG and clipboard export shows a small, readable Excalidraw logo and address, in light mode, dark mode and on transparent backgrounds.

**The Painkiller** (*solves the core pain*): Viewers no longer have to ask “what made this?”: the badge names the tool, and in SVGs it takes them there in one click.

**The Steroid** (*the magic moment*): A viewer clicks the badge and lands on a free, ready-to-use Excalidraw canvas within seconds, with no sign-up and no download.

## 2c. Goals & Non-Goals

### Goals

- Make Excalidraw visible on at least half of the exports in every format (PNG, SVG and clipboard) within three months of launch.
- Turn viewers into visitors: bring measurable traffic from shared diagrams to [excalidraw.com](https://excalidraw.com).
- Keep creators on our side: the badge is quiet enough that most creators leave it on, and exporting stays as quick as today.
- Measure it properly: every export and copy is counted, with the badge on or off.

### Non-Goals

- **Clickable links inside PNG or clipboard images.** These formats are pictures and cannot hold links; there, the logo and the readable address do the work. Pasting a linked image into rich-text apps is a later experiment (P2).

- **An “Edit this diagram” promise.** Exported images do not carry the diagram data by default, so we will not promise editing until a later version saves the drawing inside the file.
- **Rewards for keeping the badge, or paid-only removal.** We will test Avni’s reward idea only if fewer than 60% of exports keep the badge after 2–4 weeks.
- **Other surfaces.** Excalidraw+ PDF and PowerPoint exports, shareable-link previews (end-to-end encrypted, and they already show Excalidraw), a welcome note for shared-link visitors, and apps that embed the Excalidraw npm package, where the badge stays off by default.

## 2d. Success Metrics

| Goal                           | Signal                               | Metric                                                                                                                          | Target                                                                  |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Brand visibility</b>        | Exported images show the badge       | Brand Visibility Rate: exports with the badge on ÷ all image exports, per format (export events labelled attribution:on or off) | ≥50% in every format (PNG, SVG and clipboard) within 3 months of launch |
| <b>Creators keep it on</b>     | Creators leave the badge switched on | Keep rate: share of exports with the badge on, weekly, per format                                                               | ≥60% by weeks 2–4; below 60% starts the reward test                     |
| <b>Viewers become visitors</b> | Viewers click the badge              | Visits to excalidraw.com tagged utm_medium=export, by format                                                                    | Baseline in weeks 1–4; target agreed with Avni by week 5                |
| <b>Measured properly</b>       | Every export path sends an event     | Paths tracked: PNG, SVG, Export-window copy, right-click copy, Shift+Alt+C                                                      | 5 of 5 paths tracked on launch day                                      |
| <b>No harm to exporting</b>    | Creators keep exporting as often     | Weekly exports per active user, compared with the 4 weeks before launch                                                         | No drop larger than 5%                                                  |

Only a badge a person can see counts toward the Brand Visibility Rate. Hidden data, such as the code comment inside SVG files, does not count.

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

## User Journey 1: Creator exporting a diagram from excalidraw.com

**Context:** Creators decide whether the badge stays on. We optimise for zero extra steps and a badge that never gets in the way of their drawing.

### Sub-journey 1: Exporting an image (PNG or SVG)

- **[P0]** User can see the badge (a small Excalidraw logo and “Made with excalidraw.com”) in the export preview, switched on by default.
- **[P0]** User can export PNG and SVG files with the badge in the bottom-right corner, below the drawing, never covering any shape or text.
- **[P0]** User can switch the badge off, and back on, with one toggle in the Export image window labelled Add “Made with Excalidraw”.
- **[P0]** User can export in dark mode or with a transparent background and still get a readable badge.
- **[P1]** User can rely on the app to remember the badge choice for the next export in the same browser.
- **[P1]** User can export only the selected shapes, and the badge sits at the corner of that selection.
- **[P1]** User can export at 2× or 3× scale, or a very large diagram, and the badge grows with it so it stays readable when the image is shrunk.
- **[P2]** User can export a very small diagram and get a compact badge (logo and “excalidraw.com” only).

### Sub-journey 2: Copying a diagram to paste elsewhere

- **[P0]** User can copy as PNG (Export window button, right-click menu or Shift+Alt+C), and the pasted image carries the badge when it is on.
- **[P0]** User can copy as SVG from the right-click menu, and the pasted SVG keeps the clickable badge.
- **[P2]** User can paste a copied image into rich-text apps such as Google Docs, Notion or email and keep a link to excalidraw.com, if tests show those apps accept it.

## User Journey 2: Viewer discovering Excalidraw through a shared diagram

**Context:** Viewers are the new users we want. We optimise for recognising Excalidraw at a glance and reaching it in one step, even when the image cannot be clicked.

### Sub-journey 1: Recognising the tool

- **[P0]** User can tell the diagram was made with Excalidraw from the logo and text on any PNG, SVG or pasted image.

- **[P0]** User can read the address “excalidraw.com” clearly enough to type it when the image is not clickable.
- **[P1]** User can read the badge on dark web pages, because transparent exports give it a thin contrasting outline.

### **Sub-journey 2: Clicking through to Excalidraw**

- **[P0]** User can click the badge in an SVG opened in a browser or placed inside a web page, and excalidraw.com opens in a new tab.
- **[P0]** User can start drawing right after clicking, with no sign-up and no download.
- **[P1]** User can click without being tracked personally: the link carries only a campaign tag (utm\_source=excalidraw, utm\_medium=export, utm\_content=format), with no cookies and no personal data.

## **User Journey 3: Head of Marketing measuring brand visibility**

**Context:** Avni needs to report the Brand Visibility Rate per format and see whether the badge brings visitors. Tracking is assumed on, and the Head of Product owns it.

### **Sub-journey 1: Counting exports**

- **[P0]** User can see every export counted by format, including right-click and Shift+Alt+C copies, which are dropped today.
- **[P0]** User can see, for each export, whether the badge was on or off.
- **[P1]** User can see the Brand Visibility Rate and the keep rate per format, week by week.

### **Sub-journey 2: Measuring visits and testing**

- **[P1]** User can see visits to excalidraw.com that came from export badges, split by format.
- **[P2]** User can compare badge versions (no badge, text only, logo and text) in a short test with creators and viewers before full launch.

## **4. APPENDIX**

### **A. Where the badge can be clicked**

A link only works where the file format, and the place showing it, allow links. This table sets expectations for everyone.

| Where the diagram appears                             | Badge visible?  | Clickable?     | Why                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SVG opened in a browser, or placed inside a web page  | Yes             | Yes            | SVG supports links. Excalidraw already turns linked shapes into real links in SVG exports (packages/excalidraw/renderer/staticSvg Scene.ts, line 132). |
| SVG shown as an image, for example in a GitHub README | Yes             | No             | Browsers do not allow links inside images shown this way.                                                                                              |
| PNG file in docs, slides or chat                      | Yes             | No             | A PNG is a picture and cannot hold a link. The readable address does the job.                                                                          |
| Image copied to the clipboard                         | Yes             | No (today)     | Excalidraw copies only the image (packages/excalidraw/clipboard.ts, line 557). A linked version for rich-text apps is a P2 experiment.                 |
| Shareable link                                        | No badge needed | Not applicable | It already opens Excalidraw itself, with an Excalidraw preview card.                                                                                   |

## B. Badge design

- **Content:** the Excalidraw logo mark (the purple pencil) followed by “Made with [excalidraw.com](https://excalidraw.com/)”.
- **Font and size:** Excalifont, 14 px at 1× scale, growing with export scale; the logo is about the height of the text.
- **Colour:** text #46464f on light backgrounds and light grey in dark mode; logo in Excalidraw purple (#6965db). Colours follow the export’s dark-mode setting.
- **Position:** bottom-right, inside the image edge, below the drawing so it never covers it. Inside the image, it is harder to crop off than a separate strip.
- **Transparent backgrounds:** a thin contrasting outline keeps the badge readable on both light and dark pages. Our mockups showed a dark mark fading on dark pages.
- **Link:**  
[https://excalidraw.com/?utm\\_source=excalidraw&utm\\_medium=export&utm\\_content=svg](https://excalidraw.com/?utm_source=excalidraw&utm_medium=export&utm_content=svg), opening in a new tab.
- **No arrows in the text:** Excalifont has no → or ↗ characters, so they would render in a backup font.
- **Mockups:** [Attribution Mockups](#) (Option 3 shows a logo-and-address version) and the [Excalidraw Brand Kit](#).

### C. Technical notes for the Head of Product

Every file reference below links to the exact line on GitHub at commit afa3a65 (September 10, 2026), so anyone can check it. Line numbers on the newest version of the code may have moved. Full spec: [Two Tracking Additions](#).

- **New export setting:** follow the existing “Embed scene” setting: [packages/excalidraw/types.ts:416](#), [packages/excalidraw/appState.ts:71](#) and [packages/excalidraw/appState.ts:214](#), [packages/excalidraw/actions/actionExport.tsx:91](#), [packages/excalidraw/components/ImageExportDialog.tsx:85](#) and [packages/excalidraw/components/ImageExportDialog.tsx:138](#).
- **Label already translated:** [packages/excalidraw/locales/en.json:76](#) (“addWatermark”) and [packages/excalidraw/locales/en.json:111](#) (“madeWithExcalidraw”) exist in 57 language files, but no code uses them.
- **Where to draw it:** exportToCanvas ([packages/excalidraw/scene/export.ts:180](#)) and exportToSvg ([packages/excalidraw/scene/export.ts:293](#)), only when the setting is on. These functions also make library thumbnails, previews and output for apps using the npm package, so the setting defaults to off in the package and on in the excalidraw.com app.
- **Logo and link:** [packages/excalidraw/components/ExcalidrawLogo.tsx](#); reuse the SVG link code in [packages/excalidraw/renderer/staticSvgScene.ts:132](#).
- **Tracking fix 1:** [packages/excalidraw/actions/actionClipboard.tsx:128](#) and [packages/excalidraw/actions/actionClipboard.tsx:196](#) send category “element”, which the allow-list in [packages/excalidraw/analytics.ts:6](#) drops. Change them to category “export” (copyAsSvg, copyAsPng).
- **Tracking fix 2:** [packages/excalidraw/components/App.tsx:2760](#) sends trackEvent(“export”, type, “ui”). Add “attribution:on” or “attribution:off” to the label.
- **Campaign tags:** follow the app’s existing pattern, for example [excalidraw-app/components/ExcalidrawPlusPromoBanner.tsx:13](#).

### D. Decisions from Avni so far

- **September 14, 2026:** attribution must be subtle and never look like an ad. Brand guidance comes from Excalidraw’s website.
- **September 15, 2026:** on by default, and anyone can remove it. Target: 50% of exports within 3 months of rollout, across all formats. Tracking is assumed on, owned by the Head of Product. Her reward idea is to be tested later.
- **Zoom meeting after our September 17 pitch:** a small enhancement. Add the Excalidraw logo and make the attribution clickable, linking to the Excalidraw website, while keeping it simple and unobtrusive. She confirmed the badge is on by default, and that every format must reach 50% (instead of our proposed 40% minimum).

### E. Rollout and test plan

- **Weeks 0–2, test:** show creators and viewers three versions: no badge, text only (“excalidraw.com”), and logo with “Made with excalidraw.com”. Ask creators “Would you keep this on a diagram you share at work?” and viewers “What tool made this?”
- **Launch:** badge on by default in PNG, SVG and clipboard, with both tracking fixes live on the same day.
- **Weeks 2–4, check:** measure the keep rate. If it is below 60%, test a small reward for keeping the badge (Avni’s idea), such as extra AI generations.
- **Month 3, goal:** at least 50% of exports carry the badge in every format: PNG, SVG and clipboard.

## F. Open questions

- **Link destination:** excalidraw.com, which opens a free canvas right away (our recommendation), or the marketing site plus.excalidraw.com?
- **Wording:** logo with “Made with excalidraw.com”, or logo with “excalidraw.com” only? The test in E will tell.
- **Shareable links:** do they count as attributed in the Brand Visibility Rate?
- **Click target:** how many badge visits should count as success after the 4-week baseline?
- **Analytics:** does Excalidraw’s analytics tool record campaign-tagged visits to excalidraw.com? (Head of Product to confirm.)

## G. Our research

- [Excalidraw Export Audit](#): every export format tested, with screenshots.
- [Competitor Export Attribution](#): how tldraw, Miro, Whimsical, FigJam, draw.io and Lucidchart handle exports.
- [Why People Love Excalidraw](#): user psychology research and six rules for the badge.
- [Brand Visibility Rate](#): the KPI definition and the 50% target.
- [Attribution Mockups](#) and [Excalidraw Brand Kit](#): the four design options and brand colours and fonts.
- [Two Tracking Additions](#): the tracking spec for the Head of Product.
- [Brand Visibility Pitch](#): the deck from our September 17 meeting with Avni.
- GitHub history: [issue #1312](#), [PR #1365](#), [PR #3613](#), [PR #3639](#) and [issue #6607](#).